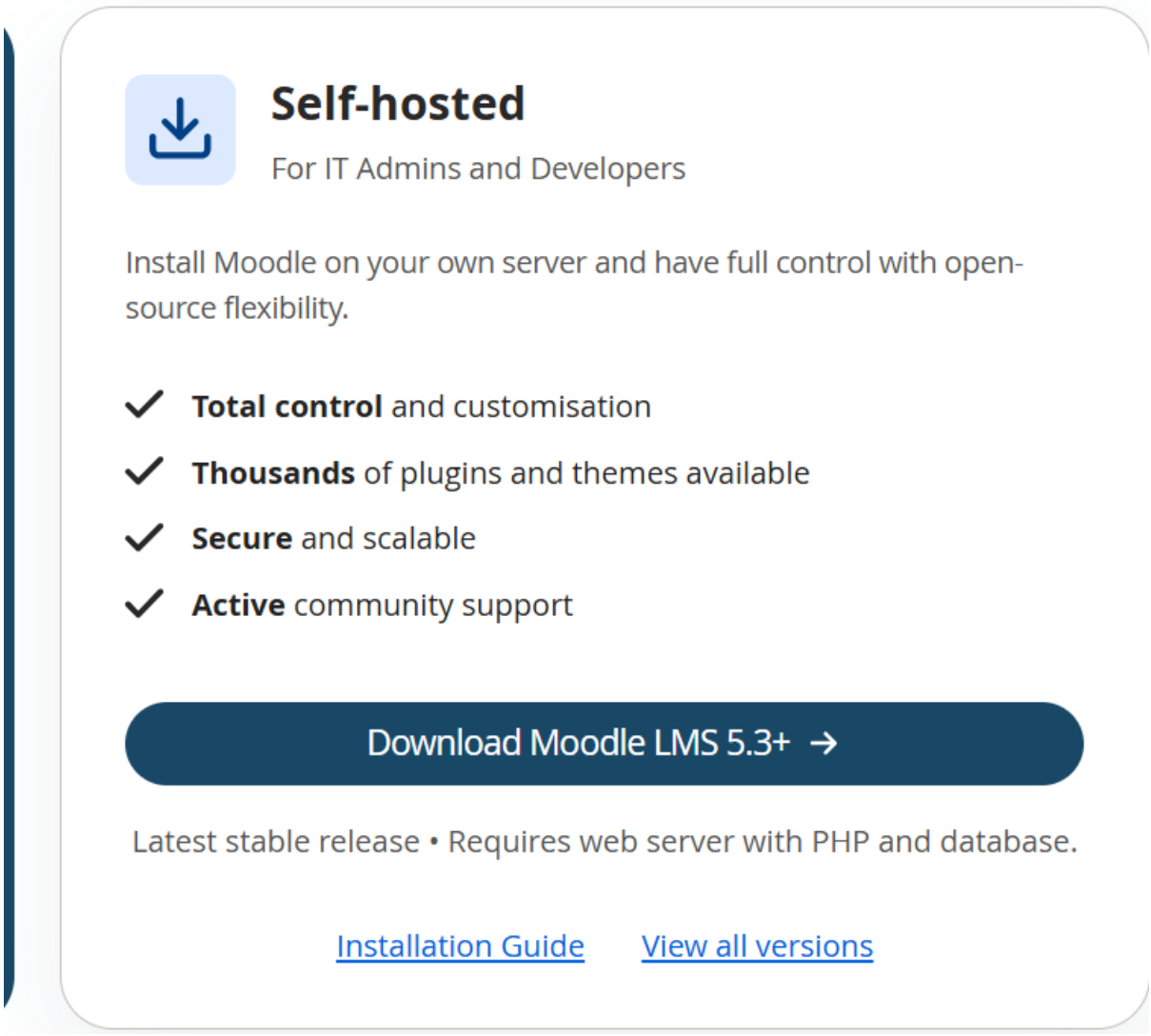
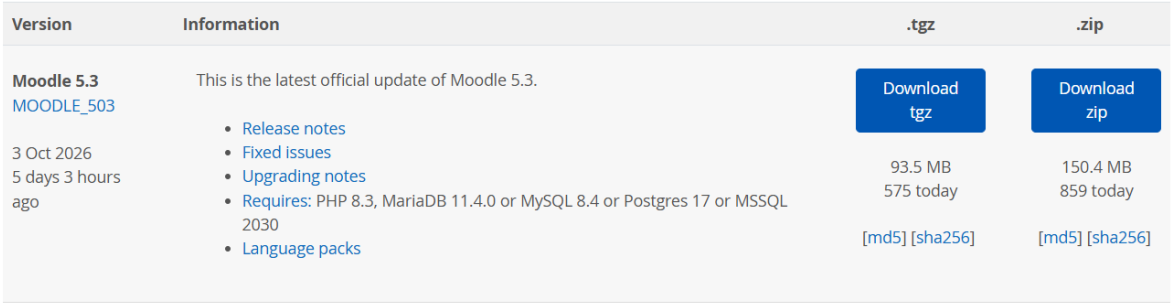
LOCAL MOODLE SET UP GUIDE

- Step 0 – Download the local moodle from the following: Home | Moodle downloads

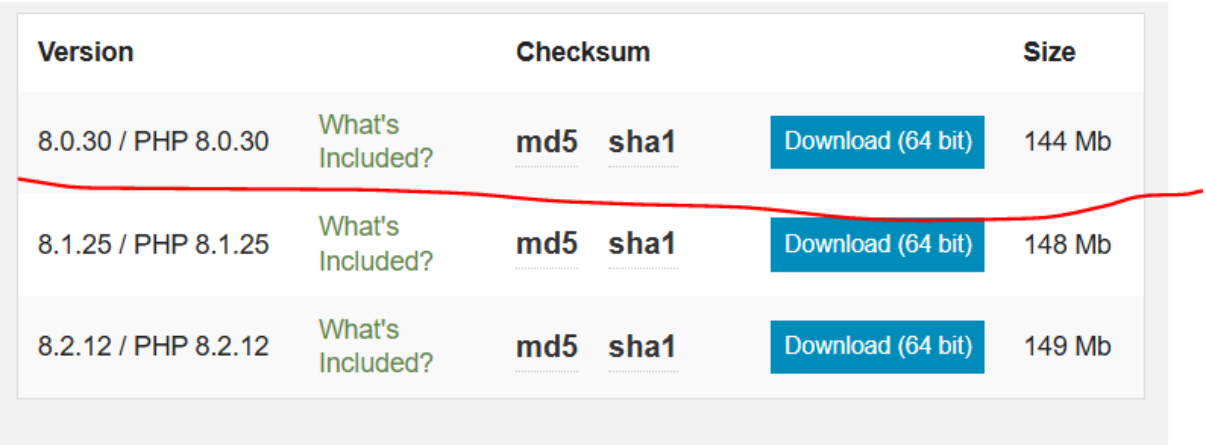




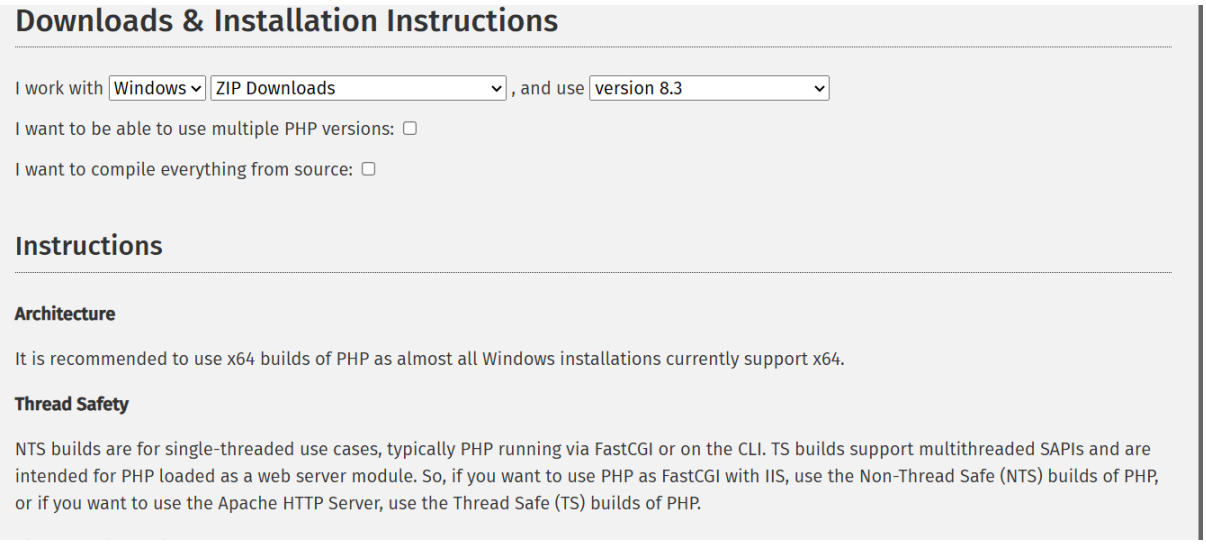
Version	Information	.tgz	.zip
Moodle 5.3 MOODLE_503 3 Oct 2026 5 days 3 hours ago	This is the latest official update of Moodle 5.3. • Release notes • Fixed issues • Upgrading notes • Requires: PHP 8.3, MariaDB 11.4.0 or MySQL 8.4 or Postgres 17 or MSSQL 2030 • Language packs	Download tgz 93.5 MB 575 today [md5] [sha256]	Download zip 150.4 MB 859 today [md5] [sha256]

- Step 1 – Download XAMPP latest version for your device

Download XAMPP

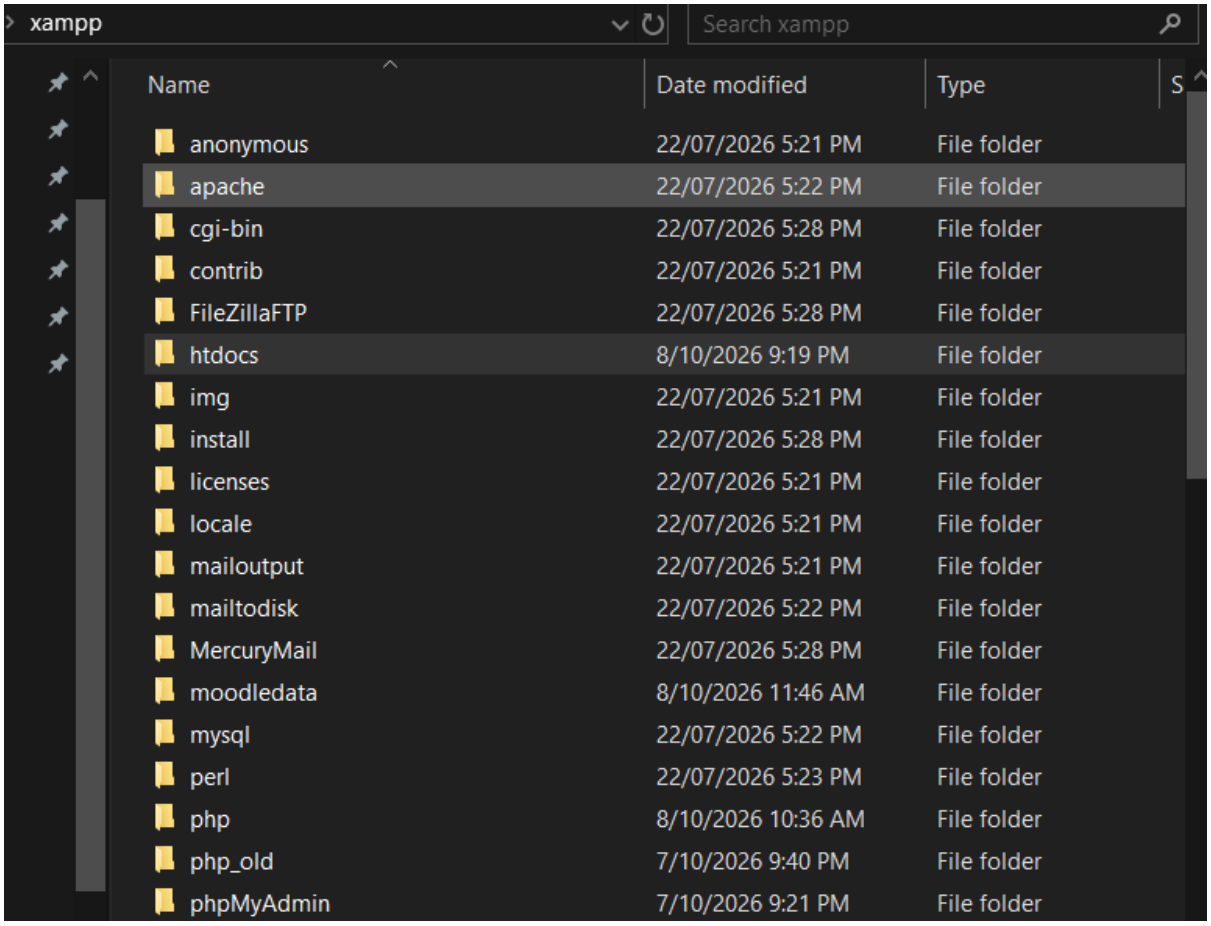


- Step 2 – Download PHP 8.3.0 from the following: PHP: Downloads





- Step 3 – Unzip the php file and put it in the xampp folder



Note: when adding it, if there is already a php file in the xamp folder you can either rename it and drag the new 8.3 version php file in there or delete the old php file and put the new php folder in xampp

- Step 3.1 – Unzip the php file

Within the php file, create a new file called “php.ini” with the following contents

extension_dir="C:\xampp\php\ext"

date.timezone=Australia/Melbourne

max_input_vars=5000

memory_limit=512M

post_max_size=40M

upload_max_filesize=40M

extension=mysqli

extension=mbstring

extension=fileinfo

extension=gd

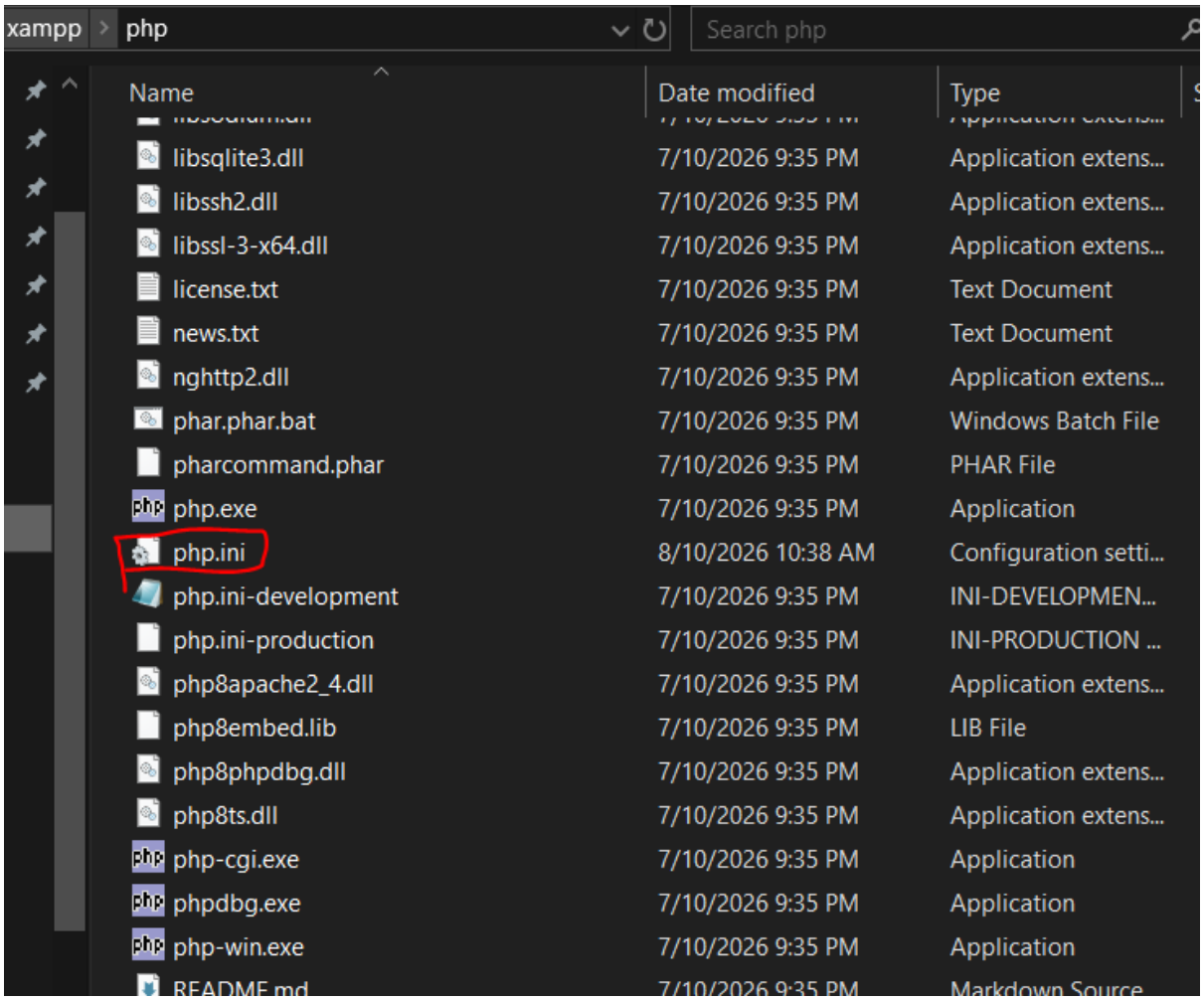
extension=intl

extension=zip

extension=sodium

extension=openssl

extension=curl



- Step 4 – access and edit the `httpd-vhosts.conf file`

The full file path is C:\xampp\apache\conf\extra\httpd-vhosts.conf

Add the following into the file at the bottom
<VirtualHost *:80>

DocumentRoot "C:/xampp/htdocs"

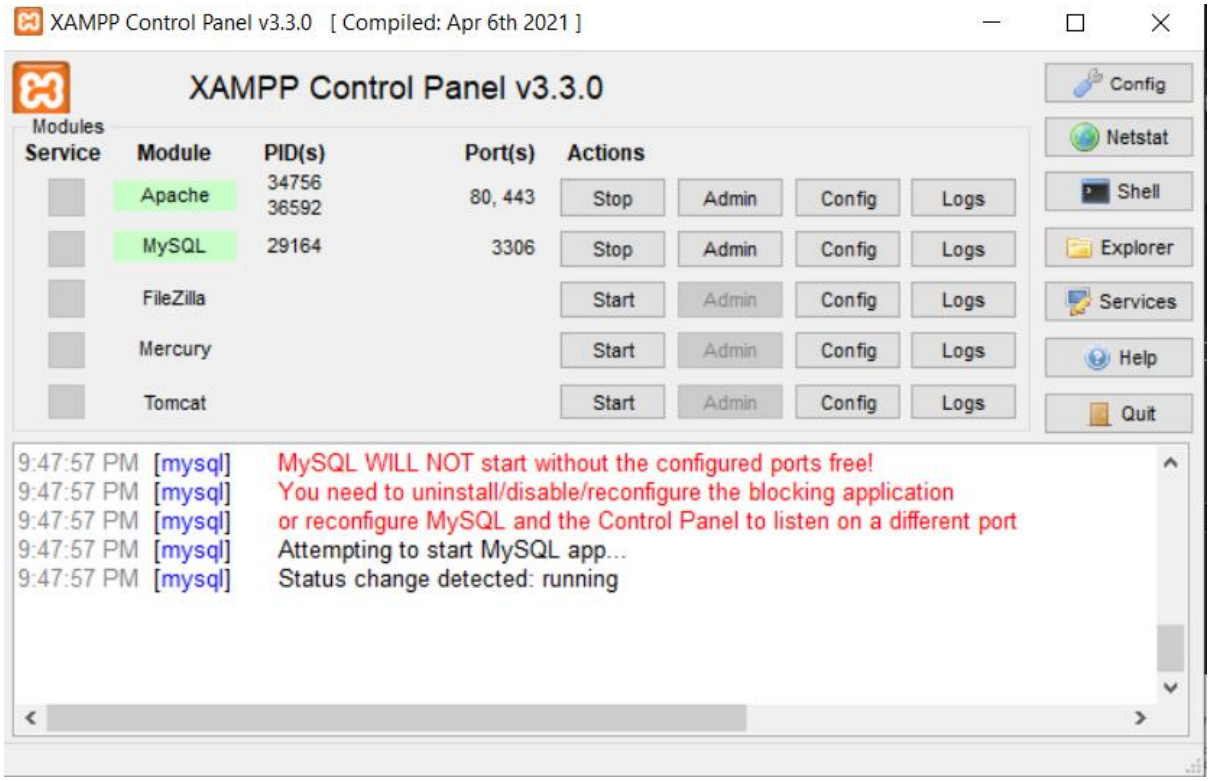
ServerName localhost

</VirtualHost>

```
<VirtualHost *:80>
    DocumentRoot "C:/xampp/htdocs/moodle/public"
    ServerName moodle.localhost
    <Directory "C:/xampp/htdocs/moodle/public">
        Options Indexes FollowSymLinks
        AllowOverride All
        Require all granted
    </Directory>
</VirtualHost>
```



- Step 5 – open up XAMPP and run BOTH the mysql AND apache server



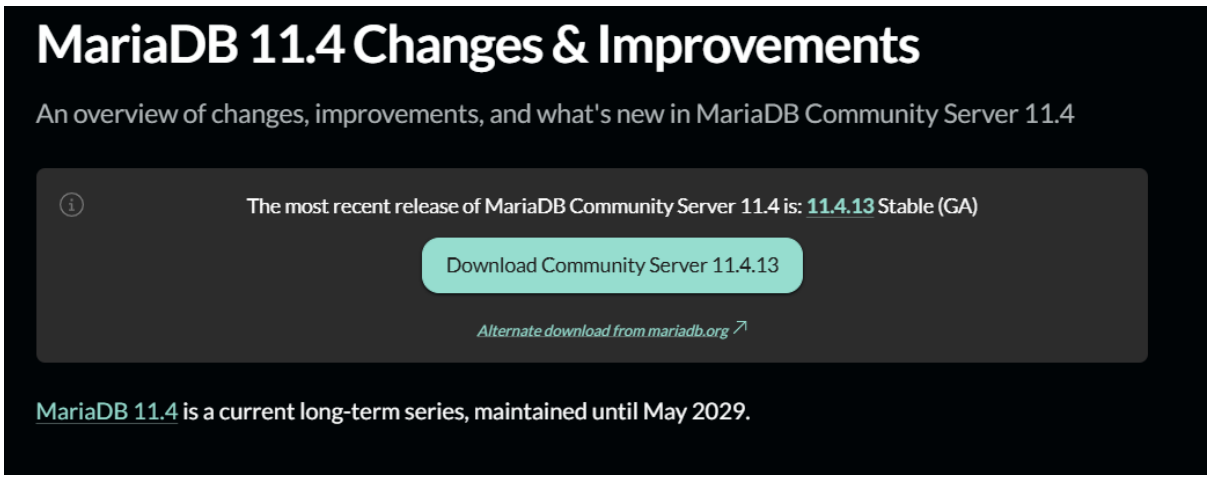
- Step 6 – Start the initial set up

To do this, access http://moodle.localhost/install.php while apache is running and follow the steps until you get to the data base steps

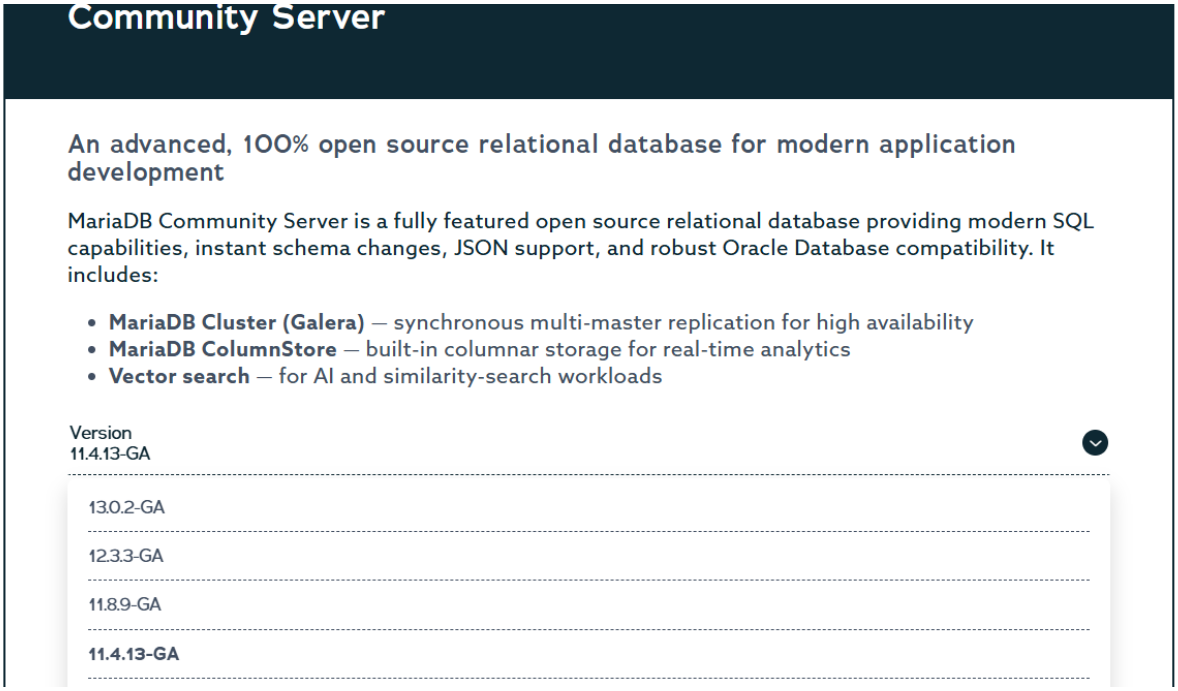
- Step 7 – Database Download

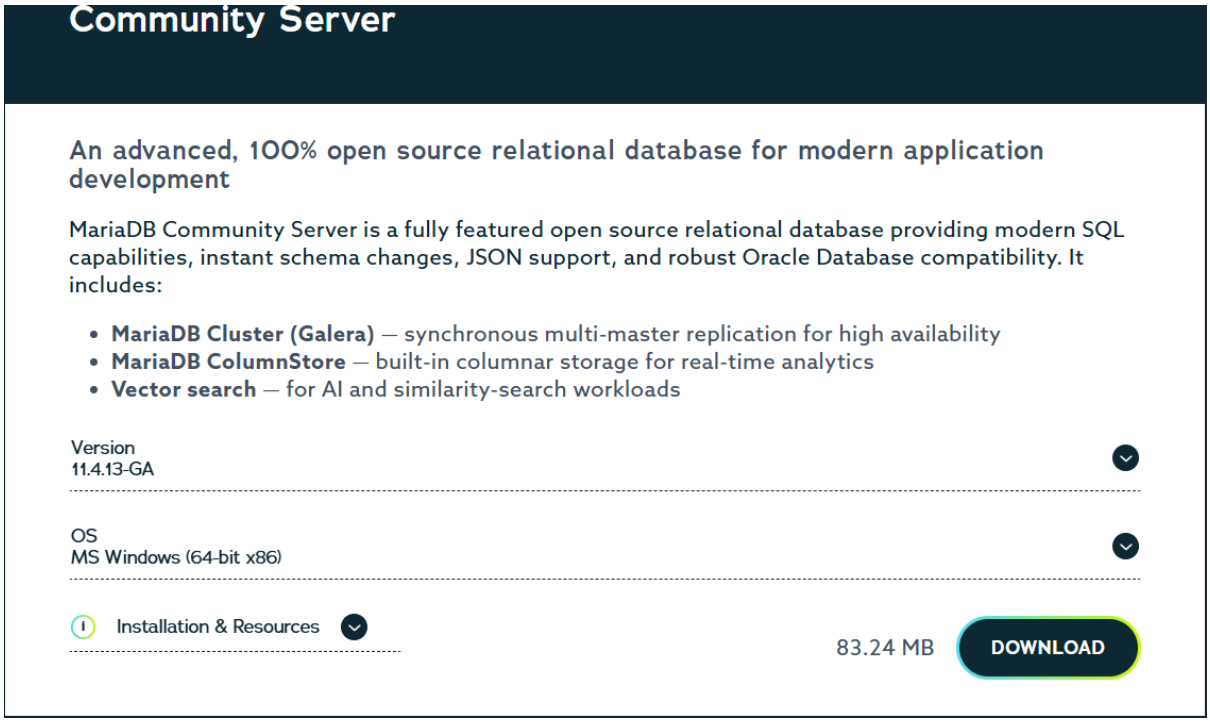
First go to this link: MariaDB 11.4 Changes & Improvements | Release Notes | MariaDB Documentation

And click “download community server 11.4.13



Select the 11.4.13 from the dropdown





Press download and it should start, do this on chrome to actually be able to download the file otherwise on ms edge it wont allow it due to being untrustworthy (dont worry it is not that case)

Once downloaded, run the program below and choose a username and root password, save the rootpassword to use later



- Step 8 – Database Set up

Eventually when going along the intial link steps from part 6, you will get to an option where you can choose what type of data base you want set up, click on the dropdown and choose maria db then press continue where you will have to fill in some sections, set as the following:

- Host - 127.0.0.1
- Port – 3306
- User – root
- Password – whatever password you set up when installing maria db is what you use here

Do NOT change the already existilg values already filled in

- Step 9 – smooth sailing

From here there shouldnt be much set up, follow the page instructions and you will eventually get up to a page where you can make an admin user and set a password then after you should be able to sign in to your moodle

LINKS:

- Fresh installer link from local host, before the vhost exists: http://localhost/moodle/public/install.php
  - keep in mind that you will need vhost existing if you want to be able to fully complete the set up
- Installer link once the vhost is working: http://moodle.localhost/install.php
- Moodle site after install: http://moodle.localhost
- Login page: http://moodle.localhost/login/index.php